YISHUN INNOVA JUNIOR COLLEGE
JC 2 PRELIMINARY EXAMINATION
Higher 2

CANDIDATE NAME			
CG		INDEX NO	

GEOGRAPHY **9173/01 (REVISED)**

Paper 2 **3 hours**

12th September 2024

Additional Materials: Answer Booklet
Insert

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

Write your name and class in the spaces at the top of this page.
Write in dark blue or black pen.
You may use an HB pencil for any diagrams or graphs.
Do not use staples, paper clips, highlighters, glue or correction fluid/tape.

The use of an approved scientific calculator is expected, where appropriate.

Answer **four** questions in total.

Section A
Both questions are compulsory.
Question 1
Question 2

Section B
Answer 1 question.

The Insert contains all the Resources referred to in the questions.
You should make reference to appropriate examples studied in the field or the classroom, even where such examples are not specifically requested by the question.
Diagrams and sketch maps should be drawn whenever they serve to illustrate an answer.
The world outline map may be annotated and handed in with relevant answers.
You are reminded of the need for good English and clear presentation in your answers.

This document consists of **5** printed pages

Section A

Structured Questions

Answer both questions in this Section

Cluster 4 : Fieldwork

1 A group of eight geography students from Sparkyi Junior College wanted to investigate Singaporeans' awareness of climate change. They chose two housing estates near the college for their study : Yishun and Canberra. Yishun, an estate with a history of around 30 years, is still classified as a non-mature estate. In contrast, Canberra is a relatively new estate, with many flats just meeting the 5-year minimum occupation period (MOP). The estates are only three minutes apart by Mass Rapid Transit (MRT).

The students formulated the following research question:

"Do residents in older housing estates have lower awareness of climate change compared to those in newer estates?"

To explore this question, they divided themselves into two groups and conducted a questionnaire survey to assess residents' awareness of climate change. They visited the two estates on a Wednesday morning during their June holidays, from 10 am to 12 pm. Since the students were less familiar with Canberra, they spent the first 30 minutes conducting an on-site field inspection there, taking photographs and recording aspects of the estate that demonstrate awareness of climate change. They noted that the population profile in Canberra housing estate seem younger than that of Yishun estate.

Using random sampling, each student surveyed 3 residents at void decks and/or coffee shops. They surveyed a total of 12 residents at each estate. However, the students encountered language barriers, as they could not converse in dialect.

Resource 1 shows a map of the 2 sites for the fieldwork. Resource 2 shows the photographs taken during the students' on-site field inspection of Canberra estate demonstrating awareness of sustainability issues. Resource 3 provides the data recording sheet used in the survey. Resource 4 presents the survey findings.

(a) Explain one strength and one weakness in the students' research question. [4]

Indicative content :

Need to identify and explain one strength and one weakness.

Strength

- **Clarity and Specificity:** The variables are clearly defined in the question. For instance, it is a study on the residents' awareness of climate change
- **Researchable** : The investigation is via survey
- **Scale is manageable** : Yishun and Canberra estates are accessible and located only 4minutes apart of each other.

Weakness

- **Potential Overgeneralisation:** The question assumes that the age of housing estates is a primary factor influencing climate change awareness, potentially overlooking other variables like education level, income, or access to information. This could lead to an oversimplification of the factors that contribute to climate awareness among residents.
- **Clarity of the 'age' of the housing estate** : There is an assumption that the results of the two estates will be representative of all estates in Singapore.
- **Researchable** : it is questionable if awareness of climate change can be deducted based on the limited cope of the questions. There can be specific question on residents' knowledge on climate change.

(b) Explain the types of secondary data the students needed to examine the research question. [4]

Indicative content

1. Demographic and Socioeconomic Data:

Since the study stated the age of the estate, then the students need to know the age of the estate. Knowing the age of the residents, education qualification, income and household income will also help to determine if the other factors influence the given variable of age of the estate.

- **Age, Education Level, and Income:** Data on the residents' age distribution, education levels, and income brackets in both older and newer estates. This can help control for variables that might influence climate change awareness.

- **Housing Estate Data:** Information on when the housing estates were built, including their age, design features, and any renovations or upgrades that have occurred over time.

2. Survey Data on Climate Change Awareness:

- **Available public Opinion Polls or Surveys:** Existing surveys or polls that measure climate change awareness across different demographic groups, ideally with data broken down by residential area or type of housing estate.
- **Environmental Attitudes Surveys:** Data on residents' attitudes towards environmental issues, energy use, recycling practices, and participation in environmental initiatives.

3. Access to Information:

- **Media Consumption Data:** Information on the types of media consumed by residents in different estates, such as newspaper readership, internet usage, or social media engagement, which can influence their awareness of climate issues.

4. Geographical and Environmental Data:

- **Proximity to Green Spaces or Environmental Hazards:** Data on the proximity of the estates to parks, industrial areas, or other environmental features that might affect residents' awareness or concern about climate change.

5. Policy and Program Data:

- **Government or NGO Initiatives:** Information on any climate change awareness programs or campaigns that have been targeted specifically at residents of older or newer housing estates.

(c) Explain how the students could minimise potential risk arising from undertaking the investigation in the two housing estates. [5]

Indicative content

1. Personal Safety:

- **Travel in Groups:** Students should conduct their fieldwork in pairs or small groups to ensure safety, particularly if they are visiting unfamiliar or less populated areas.
- **Daytime Visits:** Schedule visits during daylight hours to reduce the risk of accidents or encounters in poorly lit or unsafe areas.
- **Know the Area:** Research the housing estates beforehand to identify any high-risk areas and avoid them. Familiarize themselves with the layout, including exits and emergency contacts.

2. Health Precautions:

- **Weather Considerations:** Check weather forecasts and plan accordingly. Carry water, wear appropriate clothing, and use sunscreen if necessary to prevent heat-related issues.

(d) Explain how the students could minimise possible impact of their investigation on the residents? [4]

Indicative content

1. Interaction with Residents:

- **Respect Privacy:** Obtain informed consent from residents before conducting interviews or surveys. Make sure to explain the purpose of the investigation and ensure that participation is voluntary.
- **Cultural Sensitivity:** Be aware of and respect the cultural norms and practices of the residents in the housing estates. Avoid intrusive questions or behaviours that could be seen as disrespectful.

2. Data Security and Confidentiality:

- **Secure Data Collection:** Use secure methods for collecting and storing data, such as encrypted digital devices or locked filing systems, to protect residents' personal information.
- **Anonymize Data:** Ensure that any collected data is anonymized, especially when reporting findings, to protect the identities of the residents.

3. Legal and Ethical Considerations:

- **Obtain Permissions:** Secure any necessary permissions from local authorities or housing estate management before conducting the investigation, particularly if it involves accessing private areas.
- **Comply with Laws and Regulations:** Ensure that the investigation complies with local laws, especially regarding data collection, trespassing, and engaging with minors or vulnerable groups.

4. Emergency Preparedness:

- **Carry Emergency Contacts:** Students should have a list of emergency contacts, including their school, local authorities, and medical services.
- **First Aid Kit:** Carry a basic first aid kit to handle minor injuries that might occur during the investigation.

(e) Explain the benefits of conducting an on-site field inspection of the Canberra estate at the start of the investigation. [4]

1. Contextual Understanding:

- **Firsthand Observation:** An on-site visit allows students to observe the physical layout, infrastructure, and environmental features of the Canberra estate. This firsthand experience can provide a deeper understanding of the area, which is often more insightful than secondary sources or maps.
- **Identify Key Areas:** Students can identify specific locations within the estate that are relevant to their investigation, such as communal

areas, green spaces, and transportation hubs. This helps in planning the investigation more effectively.

2. Enhanced Research Design:

- **Refining Research Questions:** Seeing the estate in person may inspire new questions or lead to the refinement of existing research questions. Observations made during the field inspection can reveal unanticipated factors that might influence the investigation.
- **Tailored Methodology:** Based on the site visit, students can tailor their data collection methods to the specific characteristics of the estate. For example, they might adjust survey questions, choose optimal locations for interviews, or decide on appropriate sampling strategies.

3. Practical Logistics:

- **Planning Routes and Timelines:** An on-site inspection allows students to plan the most efficient routes for moving around the estate and estimate the time required for various activities. This helps in scheduling fieldwork and ensuring that all necessary areas are covered within the available time.
- **Identifying Potential Challenges:** The visit can help identify potential logistical challenges, such as difficult-to-access areas, high-traffic zones, or areas with restricted access. Addressing these challenges in advance can help avoid disruptions during the investigation.

4. Engagement with the Community:

- **Initial Interactions:** Early engagement with residents, shop owners, or community leaders during the field inspection can establish rapport and encourage cooperation during the later stages of the investigation. Building these relationships early can facilitate smoother data collection.
- **Understanding the Community Dynamics:** Observing the daily life and activities within the estate can provide insights into the community dynamics, which may be relevant to the investigation, especially if it involves assessing social behaviours or attitudes.

5. Environmental and Spatial Analysis:

- **Assessing Environmental Features:** Students can directly assess environmental features such as green spaces, waste management practices, or the presence of sustainable infrastructure. This can be particularly important if the investigation involves aspects of environmental awareness or sustainability.
- **Spatial Mapping:** On-site visits allow students to map out the estate's spatial features, such as the location of amenities, transport links, and residential clusters. This spatial understanding can be crucial for analyzing patterns and trends in the data collected.

6. Data Verification:

- **Validating Secondary Data:** The field inspection can help students verify the accuracy of secondary data sources, such as maps, demographic reports, or previous studies. Any discrepancies can be noted and addressed in the investigation plan.

(f) With reference to Resource 3, explain how the design of the data recording sheet for the survey could be improved. [5]

Indicative content :

1. Standardized Response Options:

- **Uniformity in Response Scales:** Currently, questions 1 and 2 use a frequency scale (Never/Not often/Quite often/Very often), while question 3 uses a binary scale (No/Yes). To improve consistency, consider using a similar response scale for all applicable questions. For example, question 3 could be rephrased to "How often do you take actions to reduce environmental degradation?" with the same frequency options as questions 1 and 2.

2. Structured Open-Ended Question:

- **Pre-Categorised Responses:** For question 4, where respondents are asked to list actions they take to reduce environmental degradation, it could be beneficial to provide a list of common actions with checkboxes (e.g., recycling, using energy-efficient appliances, reducing water usage) alongside an "Other" option with a space for additional responses. This makes data easier to quantify and analyze.
- **Multiple-Choice with Option to Elaborate:** Alternatively, question 4 could be designed as a multiple-choice question with options such as "Reduce waste," "Conserve energy," "Use public transport," etc., followed by an open text field for respondents to elaborate if they choose "Other."

3. Clear Instructions and Layout:

- **Instruction Clarity:** Include clear instructions at the top of the sheet on how to complete the survey, such as ticking boxes or circling answers. This ensures respondents understand how to provide their answers.
- **Consistent Layout:** Arrange the questions and response options in a consistent, easy-to-follow format. For example, place response options horizontally or vertically in the same order throughout the survey to avoid confusion.

4. Coding for Data Entry:

- **Pre-Coded Options:** Assign numerical codes to each response option (e.g., Never = 1, Not often = 2, Quite often = 3, Very often =

4, No = 0, Yes = 1). This coding should be visible on the data recording sheet to streamline data entry and analysis.

- **Subjectivity of option** : the option of 'not often', 'quite often' can be subjective and it will be more appropriate to use 'daily', 'weekly', bimonthly'.
- **Separate Columns for Responses:** Design the data recording sheet with separate columns for each respondent and their answers, with one column dedicated to each question. This structured format makes it easier to input data into spreadsheets or statistical software.

5. Demographic Information:

- **Include Demographic Section:** Adding a section to collect demographic information (e.g., age, gender, education level, and housing type) at the beginning or end of the survey could provide context for the responses and allow for more detailed analysis of trends across different groups.

6. Visual Design Enhancements:

- **Use of Grid or Table Format:** Implementing a grid or table format for responses can make the sheet visually organized, allowing respondents to follow along easily. For example, each question could have its row, and each possible response could have a column.
- **Highlight Important Sections:** Use bold text, shading, or borders to highlight key sections, such as the instructions or questions requiring written responses. This helps guide the respondent's attention and reduces the likelihood of skipped questions.

7. Pilot Testing:

- **Test and Adjust:** Before finalising the survey, conduct a pilot test with a small sample of respondents to identify any confusing elements or difficulties in the layout. Use this feedback to refine the design further.

(g) Explain the strengths and limitations of the data representation shown in Resource 4. [4]

Indicative content :

1. **Visual Clarity:**
    - The use of pie charts provides a visually pleasing, clear and immediate visual comparison between the different response categories (Never, Not often, Quite often, Very often) for each estate (Yishun and Canberra). This helps in quickly understanding the distribution of responses.

2. **Comparison Between Estates:**
    - By placing the pie charts for Yishun and Canberra side by side, the charts make it easy to compare the differences in responses between the two estates for each question. This layout supports direct comparison and highlights contrasts in behavior or attitudes.
3. **Colour Coding:**
    - The consistent use of colours across the charts for each response category helps in quickly identifying and comparing the corresponding segments across the different charts. This visual consistency aids in reducing cognitive load.
4. **Percentage Labels:**
    - The inclusion of percentage labels on each segment of the pie charts provides precise quantitative information, making it easier to interpret the proportion of respondents in each category.

Limitations of the Data Representation:

1. **Limited Insight into Small Differences:**
    - Pie charts are less effective at showing small differences between categories, particularly when the segments are close in size. This can make it difficult to detect nuanced variations in responses.
2. **Potential Misinterpretation:**
    - Pie charts can sometimes be misleading, as the visual size of the segments may not always correspond accurately with the percentage values, especially when the chart segments are small. This could potentially lead to misinterpretation of the data.
3. **Lack of Contextual Information:**
    - The pie charts provide no information about the total number of respondents, which is crucial for understanding the significance of the percentages. Without knowing the sample size, it's challenging to assess the reliability of the data.
4. **Overuse of Pie Charts:**
    - While pie charts are useful for showing proportions, using them for multiple comparisons can clutter the presentation and make it harder to interpret the overall trends. Alternative representations like bar charts might offer a clearer comparison across multiple categories.
5. **No Indication of Statistical Significance:**
    - The pie charts do not provide any indication of whether the differences between the estates are statistically significant.

This limitation means that the visual differences observed may not be meaningful without further statistical analysis.

(h) The students concluded that the residents in younger estates in Singapore has better awareness of climate change than the residents in older estates in Singapore. Evaluate the validity of their conclusion. [10]

Indicative content

1. Data Scope and Representation:
   - Limited Data Points: The conclusion is based on only two questions related to air-conditioning use and car sharing/public transport use. While these behaviors might be related to environmental awareness, they do not directly measure awareness of climate change. Awareness encompasses knowledge, attitudes, and actions specifically related to climate change, which are not fully captured by the questions provided.
   - Limited Sample: The data only represents two estates—Yishun (presumably older) and Canberra (presumably younger). These two locations may not be representative of all older and younger estates in Singapore. Generalizing findings from these two estates to all estates in Singapore could be problematic.
   -
2. Assumption Linking Behaviour to Awareness:
   - Behavior vs. Awareness: The students are assuming that more environmentally-friendly behaviors (e.g., using public transport or less frequent air-conditioning use) are directly indicative of greater climate change awareness. However, behaviors can be influenced by various factors such as economic constraints, lifestyle preferences, or infrastructure availability, which might not necessarily reflect a resident's awareness of climate change.
   - Direct Measurement of Awareness: The survey questions do not directly assess respondents' knowledge or attitudes about climate change. Therefore, concluding better climate change awareness based on these behaviors alone is speculative without more direct measures of awareness.
   -
3. Potential Confounding Variables:
   - Socioeconomic Factors: Younger estates might have newer infrastructure, better public transport links, or more energy-efficient buildings, which could influence residents' behavior regardless of their awareness of climate change. Differences in income, education level, and cultural background could also play significant roles in both behavior and awareness, but these factors are not accounted for in the data.
   - Accessibility of Resources: Residents in newer estates might have better access to resources that encourage environmentally-friendly behaviors, such as more accessible public transportation or more energy-efficient housing, which could explain their behaviors without necessarily indicating higher climate change awareness.
   -
4. Sample Size and Statistical Significance:
   - Sample Size Information Missing: The pie charts do not provide information on the sample size, which is crucial for evaluating the reliability of the conclusions. Without knowing how many people were surveyed, it's impossible to assess whether the differences observed are statistically significant or just due to random variation.

- Lack of Statistical Analysis: The data representation does not include any statistical tests to determine whether the observed differences in behaviour between the two estates are significant. Without such analysis, the conclusion might be based on potentially insignificant differences.

5. Broader Context:
   - Environmental Actions vs. Awareness: Even if younger estate residents engage in more environmentally-friendly behaviours, this does not necessarily imply greater awareness of climate change. For example, residents might use public transport more frequently due to better availability in newer estates, not because they are more concerned about climate change.

Conclusion:
The conclusion that residents in younger estates in Singapore have better awareness of climate change than those in older estates is premature and lacks sufficient evidence. The data used to support this conclusion is limited, does not directly measure climate change awareness, and does not account for confounding variables that could influence the observed behaviors. To make a valid conclusion, more comprehensive data would be needed, including direct measures of climate change awareness, a larger and more representative sample, and statistical analysis to confirm the significance of any observed differences.

Appendix A

Levels	Marks	Generic Level Descriptors for H2 Fieldwork Evaluative Question
3	9–10	Evaluation is analytical and coherent. Response addresses the question and demonstrates good knowledge and understanding of fieldwork methods relevant to the given context.
2	5–8	Evaluation is mostly analytical and coherent. Weaker responses in this level will have evaluation that is broadly analytical and generally coherent. Response generally addresses the question and demonstrates adequate knowledge and understanding of fieldwork methods relevant to the given context.
1	1–4	Response is descriptive with limited or no analysis and evaluation. Response is fragmented and lacks clarity. Response lacks focus on the question and may be largely irrelevant to it. Response shows basic knowledge and understanding of fieldwork methods. Response has some, though limited, relevance to the given context.
0	0	No creditworthy response

Cluster 3 : Sustainable Future and Climate Change

2 Resource 5 shows the most and least green countries in the world. Resource 6 shows the most liveable cities of China by expatriates. Resource 7 shows the most liveable cities of India. Resource 8A and 8B show the sexual harassment of women in the EU.

(a) Cite data from Resource 5 to describe the variation of green countries in the world. [4]

1. Top Green Countries:
- **Sweden** is ranked as the most green country in the world.
- **Denmark** (2nd), **UK** (3rd), **Finland** (4th), and **Switzerland** (5th) are also in the top five.
- European countries dominate the top rankings, with many in Western Europe appearing in the top 15. These include **France** (6th), **Austria** (15th), and **Luxembourg** (12th).
- **Norway** (9th) is highlighted for leading in Green Transport according to the Global Footprint Index (GFI).

2. Notable Green Countries Outside Europe:
- **Japan** (19th) is recognized for leading in nuclear energy production growth.
- **Costa Rica** (7th) is noted for having the highest rate of recycling in Latin America.
- **New Zealand** ranks 17th globally, demonstrating strong environmental practices in Oceania.
- **Ecuador** (20th) is one of the leading countries in protecting marine ecosystems according to the Environmental Performance Index (EPI).

3. Countries with Lower Environmental Performance:
- Countries with the least green rankings include **Indonesia** (63rd), **Malaysia** (62nd), and **Vietnam** (64th) in Southeast Asia.
- **Saudi Arabia** (65th), **Kuwait** (60th), and **Iran** (68th) in the Middle East are among the least green.
- **China** (66th) and **Turkey** (67th) are also among the lower-ranked countries in terms of environmental sustainability.

4. Regional Variations:
- **Europe** generally shows high environmental performance, with many countries in the top 20.
- **Asia** has a significant range of rankings, with Japan performing well, while other countries like China and Vietnam rank much lower.
- **Middle Eastern** countries are predominantly in the lower ranks, indicating challenges in environmental sustainability.
- **Latin America** has a mix of performance, with Costa Rica ranking highly but others like Ecuador (20th) showing room for improvement.

5. Specific Achievements:

- **France** is highlighted for its high score in the EPI's Terrestrial Biome Protection indicator.
- **Switzerland** achieved a perfect score in both the EPI's sanitation and drinking water indicators.

This variation shows a significant disparity in how countries around the world manage and prioritize environmental sustainability, with European nations generally leading and several Asian and Middle Eastern countries lagging behind.

(b) Using Resources 5, 6 and 7, explain the tension between sustainable urban development and liveability. [5]

1. Cost of Living vs. Sustainability:

- **High Cost of Living:** In the Chinese cities listed, such as Shanghai and Shenzhen, the cost of living is significantly high (US$1,950 and US$1,650 per month, respectively). These cities also score high on liveability factors such as safety and nightlife. However, maintaining such high liveability standards often comes with environmental costs, such as high energy consumption, significant waste generation, and extensive use of resources. The tension arises when trying to balance maintaining high liveability with the need for sustainable practices.
- **Sustainability Focus:** On the other hand, cities that prioritize sustainability may have lower living costs and may not provide the same level of liveability amenities, especially when it comes to high-cost urban services like extensive nightlife or high standards of urban safety. In the Indian context, while cities like Bengaluru and Pune score high on liveability, their sustainability scores (which contribute 20% to the overall score) may suggest that even in these top cities, the balance between providing a high quality of life and maintaining sustainability is challenging.

2. Urban Amenities vs. Environmental Impact:

- **Urban Amenities:** Cities with vibrant nightlife and high safety, such as Shanghai and Shenzhen, indicate a strong emphasis on urban amenities that enhance liveability. However, these amenities often require significant resource consumption, contributing to higher carbon footprints, energy use, and waste. This raises the issue of whether such cities can maintain their level of amenities while transitioning to more sustainable practices.
- **Environmental Impact:** The pursuit of liveability in terms of enhanced urban amenities can strain the city's resources, potentially leading to unsustainable development. For instance, extensive nightlife activities require significant energy consumption, while maintaining high safety standards could lead to extensive use of surveillance technologies, which have both environmental and social implications.

3. Balancing Development Goals:

- **Trade-offs:** The Indian cities listed in the infographic, such as Bengaluru and Pune, show that cities can be highly liveable but face the challenge of ensuring that this liveability does not come at the expense of sustainability. Urban planners often face trade-offs between improving liveability (e.g., better infrastructure, more amenities) and enhancing sustainability (e.g., reducing energy consumption, preserving green spaces).
- **Policy Implications:** To address this tension, urban policies need to focus on integrated approaches that do not compromise environmental sustainability for liveability. For instance, promoting public transport, green building practices, and energy-efficient infrastructure can help bridge this gap. The weightage given to sustainability (20%) and quality of life (35%) in the Indian cities ranking suggests an acknowledgment of this balance, yet the relatively lower weight for sustainability indicates that more focus could be necessary to align these development goals fully.

Conclusion:

The data from both India and China highlights the inherent tension between striving for high liveability and ensuring sustainable urban development. As cities aim to provide better amenities, safety, and overall quality of life, they must also consider the long-term environmental impact of these developments. Balancing these aspects is crucial for creating cities that are not only liveable today but sustainable for future generations.

(c) Explain the subjective nature of liveability using Resources 6 and 7. [5]

The concept of liveability is highly subjective because it is influenced by individual preferences, values, and circumstances, all of which can vary widely from person to person. Liveability often includes factors like access to amenities, environmental quality, safety, healthcare, and education, but the importance of these factors can differ based on personal priorities.

For instance, someone who values physical geography might prioritize natural landscapes, climate, or access to outdoor activities when assessing liveability. In contrast, another person might focus on human geography aspects, such as cultural diversity, economic opportunities, or social services.

Moreover, your belief that geography evolves quickly underscores the idea that liveability is not static; it changes as cities and communities develop or decline. What makes a place liveable today might not hold true in the future, as human geography shifts due to factors like economic growth, migration, or changes in public policy.

The idea of being well-informed in geography, as you emphasize, also plays into the subjective nature of liveability. Understanding the "what, why, how, and when" of a place allows individuals to make more informed decisions about where they would like to live, based on their unique needs and goals.

In summary, liveability is a deeply personal and evolving concept, shaped by an individual's geography, both physical and human, and their understanding of the world around them.
(Use the data from China and India to prove the above pointers)

(d) Account for why there is a need to focus on gender equality for progress towards liveable cities. [5]

Focusing on gender equality is crucial for advancing liveable cities for several reasons:

1. **Inclusive Decision-Making:** Gender equality ensures that both men and women are involved in decision-making processes. This leads to more comprehensive and balanced urban planning and policies that address the needs of all residents. For instance, women's perspectives might highlight the importance of accessible childcare facilities or safe public spaces, which contribute to a more liveable environment.
2. **Economic Benefits:** Gender equality can boost economic growth by ensuring that all individuals have equal opportunities to contribute to the economy. Women's full participation in the workforce can lead to increased productivity and economic dynamism, which enhances the overall quality of life in a city.
3. **Social Equity:** A focus on gender equality promotes social justice and reduces inequalities. When cities are designed with gender considerations in mind, they become more equitable places where everyone has access to resources, services, and opportunities, leading to improved social cohesion and well-being.
4. **Safety and Security:** Gender-sensitive urban planning can improve safety and security for all residents. For example, well-lit public spaces, safe transportation options, and accessible emergency services are crucial for everyone, particularly women and marginalized groups who may face higher risks of violence and discrimination.
5. **Health and Well-being:** Gender equality can enhance public health outcomes. Cities that address gender-specific health needs and ensure equal access to healthcare services contribute to better overall health and well-being for all residents.
6. **Sustainable Development:** Gender equality supports sustainable development by fostering diverse perspectives and solutions to environmental and social challenges. Women often play key roles in community-based environmental initiatives and sustainable practices, contributing to more resilient and adaptive urban environments.

By prioritizing gender equality, cities can become more inclusive, equitable, and responsive to the needs of all their inhabitants, ultimately leading to more liveable and thriving urban areas.

(e) Using all Resources, explain whether creating liveable cities for women is achievable. [6]

The view that liveable cities for women can be created is both feasible and supported by evidence, but it requires deliberate and multifaceted approaches. Here's an evaluation of this view:

Feasibility

1. **Evidence of Success:**
    - **Best Practices:** Cities around the world have successfully implemented policies and practices that improve liveability for women. For example, cities like Copenhagen and Stockholm have integrated gender-sensitive urban planning, such as safe public spaces, accessible childcare, and extensive public transportation systems.
    - **Policy Frameworks:** Many international frameworks and guidelines, such as the UN's Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and the New Urban Agenda, emphasize the need for gender-responsive urban planning and provide a basis for action.
2. **Technical and Policy Innovations:**
    - **Urban Design:** Advances in urban design and planning can be leveraged to create safer and more inclusive spaces. Technologies and strategies such as smart lighting, public surveillance, and community-based safety programs have been effectively used in various cities.
    - **Legislation:** Governments can enact policies that promote gender equality and address specific needs of women, such as affordable childcare, equal pay, and protection against gender-based violence.
3. **Community Engagement:**
    - **Inclusive Participation:** Engaging women in the planning and decision-making processes helps ensure that their needs are addressed. This participatory approach has proven effective in various urban development projects.

Challenges

1. **Implementation Barriers:**
    - **Resource Constraints:** Limited financial and human resources can hinder the implementation of gender-sensitive policies and infrastructure improvements.

- **Resistance to Change:** Social and cultural resistance to gender equality can impede progress. Changing entrenched attitudes and practices requires time and persistent effort.

2. **Intersectionality:**
   - **Diverse Needs:** Women are not a monolithic group; their needs vary based on factors such as race, class, age, and disability. Creating liveable cities requires addressing these intersecting needs comprehensively.
   - **Tailored Solutions:** Solutions must be tailored to specific contexts and communities, rather than applying a one-size-fits-all approach.
3. **Sustainability:**
   - **Long-Term Commitment:** Ensuring that improvements are sustained over time requires ongoing commitment from policymakers, continuous community engagement, and regular evaluation of policies and practices.

Conclusion

Creating liveable cities for women is both a realistic and essential goal. It is achievable through targeted policies, community engagement, and innovative urban design. However, it requires overcoming significant challenges, including resource limitations, social resistance, and the need for intersectional approaches. The success of creating such cities depends on the commitment of governments, communities, and stakeholders to prioritize gender equality and inclusivity in urban development.
4o mini

(f) Account for the varying success of strategies to address the issues faced by women living in cities. [5]

The varying success of strategies to address the issues faced by women living in cities can be attributed to several factors:

1. Contextual Factors

- **Local Needs and Priorities:** Strategies need to be tailored to the specific needs and priorities of women in different cities. What works in one context may not be effective in another due to differences in cultural norms, economic conditions, and social structures.
- **Resource Availability:** Cities with more resources and better infrastructure may implement strategies more effectively. In contrast, cities with limited resources may struggle to adopt and sustain comprehensive initiatives.

2. Implementation Challenges

- **Political Will and Governance:** Successful implementation often depends on the political will and commitment of local governments.

Inconsistent support or lack of coordination among various levels of government can undermine the effectiveness of strategies.

- **Bureaucratic Obstacles:** Inefficiencies and bureaucratic hurdles can delay or complicate the execution of gender-sensitive policies. Streamlined processes and effective management are crucial for success.

3. Community Engagement and Participation

- **Inclusivity:** Strategies that involve active participation from women and community organizations tend to be more successful. Engaging women in the design and implementation phases ensures that their needs are accurately addressed.
- **Public Support:** Public attitudes towards gender equality can impact the success of strategies. In cities where there is strong community support for gender-sensitive initiatives, these strategies are more likely to be effective.

4. Economic and Social Factors

- **Economic Stability:** Economic conditions can influence the success of strategies. In economically stable environments, cities may have more capacity to invest in and sustain gender-sensitive initiatives compared to cities facing economic hardships.
- **Social Norms and Attitudes:** Deep-seated social norms and attitudes towards gender roles can affect the success of strategies. Cities with progressive attitudes towards gender equality are more likely to see positive outcomes.

5. Policy Design and Implementation

- **Evidence-Based Approaches:** Strategies based on thorough research and evidence tend to be more successful. Data-driven approaches help in understanding the specific issues and evaluating the impact of interventions.
- **Integration and Coordination:** Successful strategies often involve integrating gender considerations across various sectors (e.g., transportation, healthcare, housing). Coordinated efforts between different departments and agencies enhance effectiveness.

6. Evaluation and Adaptation

- **Monitoring and Feedback:** Regular evaluation and feedback mechanisms are essential for assessing the success of strategies and making necessary adjustments. Strategies that incorporate ongoing monitoring and adapt based on feedback are more likely to address emerging challenges effectively.
- **Flexibility:** The ability to adapt strategies in response to changing conditions or unforeseen challenges contributes to their success. Flexible approaches allow for adjustments based on real-time data and evolving needs.

Conclusion

The varying success of strategies to address the issues faced by women in cities reflects the complex interplay of contextual, economic, social, and policy-related factors. Tailoring strategies to local needs, ensuring effective implementation, engaging the community, and maintaining flexibility are key to overcoming challenges and achieving positive outcomes.

Section B

Answer **EITHER** question 3 **OR** question 4.

Cluster 3 : Sustainable Future and Climate Change

EITHER

3 "Contemporary climate change impact everyone in the same way."
Evaluate the statement. [20]

The statement "Contemporary climate change impacts everyone in the same way" is not entirely accurate. While climate change affects everyone to some extent, its impacts vary widely based on a range of factors. Here's an evaluation of the statement:

****1. Differential Vulnerability**

- **Geographical Differences:** Climate change impacts vary by location. For example, coastal areas face higher risks of sea-level rise and extreme weather events, while inland regions might experience different challenges such as heatwaves or droughts. Cities and communities in different geographic locations will experience different effects based on their specific environmental conditions.
- **Economic Disparities:** Economic status plays a significant role in determining vulnerability. Wealthier individuals and nations often have more resources to adapt to and mitigate climate change impacts, such as building resilient infrastructure or relocating. In contrast, poorer communities may lack the resources to cope with the same challenges, making them more vulnerable to climate impacts.

****2. Social and Demographic Factors**

- **Social Inequality:** Social factors such as race, gender, and age can influence how climate change impacts individuals. For instance, women, especially in developing countries, may face higher risks due to existing gender inequalities. Children and the elderly are also particularly vulnerable to health impacts related to extreme weather and changing climate conditions.
- **Health and Well-being:** People with pre-existing health conditions or those living in areas with inadequate healthcare systems may suffer more from climate-related health impacts, such as heat stress or respiratory issues from air pollution.

****3. Economic Activities and Livelihoods**

- **Dependence on Climate-Sensitive Sectors:** Individuals and communities dependent on climate-sensitive sectors, such as agriculture or fishing, are more directly affected by climate change. Changes in temperature, precipitation patterns, and ocean conditions can drastically impact their livelihoods.
- **Urban vs. Rural:** Urban and rural areas face different climate-related challenges. Urban areas may deal with the urban heat island effect and

increased air pollution, while rural areas might face issues like water scarcity or crop failures.

**4. Adaptation and Resilience

- **Adaptation Capacity:** The ability to adapt to climate change varies significantly. Communities with better access to technology, information, and resources are generally better equipped to deal with climate impacts. Those with less capacity for adaptation, such as marginalized communities or developing regions, may experience more severe consequences.
- **Infrastructure and Services:** The quality of infrastructure and public services affects how climate change impacts are experienced. Well-developed infrastructure can provide better protection against extreme weather events, while inadequate infrastructure can exacerbate vulnerabilities.

**5. Global vs. Local Impacts

- **Global Perspective:** On a global scale, climate change is a universal issue, affecting all countries and populations to varying degrees. However, the local manifestations of climate change are highly diverse, influenced by local climate, geography, and socio-economic conditions.
- **Local Solutions:** Solutions and responses to climate change also vary locally. While global agreements and frameworks provide a broad approach, effective responses often need to be tailored to local conditions and needs.

Conclusion

The statement that "contemporary climate change impacts everyone in the same way" overlooks the significant variations in how climate change affects different populations. Factors such as geography, economic status, social inequalities, and adaptation capacities create diverse experiences of climate impacts. While climate change is a global issue, its effects are unevenly distributed, and addressing these disparities is crucial for developing effective and equitable solutions.

OR

4 Evaluate the view that effective slum management is important for progress towards sustainable urban development. [20]

The view that effective slum management is important for progress towards sustainable urban development is well-founded. Here's an evaluation of this view:

**1. Addressing Basic Needs and Improving Quality of Life

- Basic Services: Effective slum management addresses fundamental needs such as access to clean water, sanitation, healthcare, and education. Improving these services in slum areas enhances the overall quality of life and contributes to sustainable urban development by ensuring that all residents have access to essential resources.
- Health Outcomes: Better management of slums can lead to improved health conditions by reducing exposure to environmental hazards and improving living standards. This can reduce the burden on public health systems and contribute to overall urban resilience.

**2. Economic Development and Livelihoods

- Economic Opportunities: Slum management often involves initiatives to support economic development, such as job training, microfinance, and entrepreneurial support. Improving economic opportunities in slum areas can lead to increased incomes and economic stability, contributing to broader urban economic development.
- Informal Economy: Slums often host a significant portion of the informal economy. Effective management can help integrate these economic activities into the formal economy, improving regulation, security, and benefits for workers and businesses.

**3. Social Inclusion and Equity

- Reducing Inequality: Slum management is essential for reducing social and spatial inequalities. By improving living conditions and providing better access to services and opportunities, slum management helps bridge the gap between different socio-economic groups.
- Community Empowerment: Engaging slum residents in planning and decision-making processes empowers them and ensures that interventions are relevant and effective. This participatory approach promotes social cohesion and resilience.

**4. Environmental Sustainability

- Environmental Improvements: Effective slum management often includes initiatives to address environmental challenges such as waste management, pollution, and inadequate infrastructure. By improving these aspects, slum management contributes to the overall environmental sustainability of urban areas.
- Urban Planning: Integrating slum areas into broader urban planning efforts helps ensure that development is sustainable and resilient. This includes considering slum areas in green space planning, transportation networks, and infrastructure development.

**5. Disaster Resilience

- Risk Reduction: Slum areas are often highly vulnerable to natural and man-made disasters. Effective management includes measures to reduce these risks, such as improving housing quality, strengthening infrastructure, and enhancing emergency preparedness. This contributes to overall urban resilience and sustainability.
- Infrastructure Improvement: Upgrading infrastructure in slum areas can mitigate the impacts of disasters and improve overall urban safety. Resilient infrastructure helps cities cope with challenges such as flooding, heatwaves, and other climate-related impacts.

**6. Challenges and Limitations

- Resource Constraints: Effective slum management requires significant resources and coordination among various stakeholders. Resource limitations can hinder the implementation and sustainability of management initiatives.
- Political Will and Governance: The success of slum management efforts depends on political will and effective governance. Inadequate political support or corruption can undermine efforts and limit progress.
- Complexity of Issues: Slum management involves addressing complex and interrelated issues such as poverty, social exclusion, and inadequate infrastructure. Comprehensive and integrated approaches are needed to address these challenges effectively.

Conclusion

Effective slum management is indeed crucial for progress towards sustainable urban development. It addresses key aspects of quality of life, economic development, social inclusion, environmental sustainability, and disaster resilience. However, achieving effective slum management requires overcoming significant challenges, including resource constraints and the need for coordinated efforts. When managed well, slum improvements contribute to a more equitable, resilient, and sustainable urban environment.

[Total : 90 marks]